5. Avoid touching your face, nose or mouth while preparing food.
6. Avoid coughing or sneezing around food. Close your mouth by using hand kerchief while you cough in public places.
7. If you want to taste the food, use a clean spoon.
8. Change your clothes regularly and wash them cleanly, especially undergarments.
9. Do not defecate in open field. Use clean toilets for defecation.
10. If you are not well, avoid self-medication and consult a doctor.

Activity 5

Answer the following questions.

- Do you exercise regularly?
- Do you keep yourself clean?
- When do you go to bed?
- When do you get up?

Compare your response with that of your friends. Do you think you need to change yourself? Discuss with your teacher.

Points to Remember

- Adolescence is the period of reproductive maturity which lies usually between the ages of 11 to 19 years.
- Voice of boys becomes harsh as chords of voice box get loosened and thickened during adolescence.
- Hormones are the secretions of endocrine glands without ducts which secrete them directly into the bloodstream.
- Testosterone is the male hormone and estrogen is the female hormone that bring about development of several secondary sex characters.
- The uterine wall in female prepares itself to receive the developing fertilized eggs. In case there is no fertilization, the thickened lining of the uterus wall breaks down and goes out of the body along with the blood. This is called menstruation.
- It is important to take balanced diet for the overall growth and development during adolescence.

A-Z GLOSSARY

Adam's Apple	The protruding part of the throat.
Adolescence	The period of transition from childhood to adulthood.
Gland	Group of cells which secrete hormones.
Hormones	The chemical substances secreted in the body.
Menarche	The first menstrual flow at puberty.
Menopause	The stoppage of menstruation.
Menstruation	Bleeding in the reproductive tract of women.
Ovulation	The release of ovum from the ovary.
Primary sex characters	The characters which refer to changes in sex organs.
Puberty	The period at which an organism attains sexual maturity.
Secondary sex characters	The characters which help to distinguish the male from the female.

8th_Science_Unit-20_EM.indd 240 23/01/2024 11:04:23